

leged redressable injury sufficient to meet the requirements of Art. III, the Court has refrained from adjudicating "abstract questions of wide public significance" which amount to "generalized grievances," pervasively shared and most appropriately addressed in the representative branches. *Id.*, at 499-500.¹¹ Finally, the Court has required that the plaintiff's complaint fall within "the zone of interests to be protected or regulated by the statute or constitutional guarantee in question." *Association of Data Processing Service Orgs. v. Camp*, 397 U. S. 150, 153 (1970).¹²

Merely to articulate these principles is to demonstrate their close relationship to the policies reflected in the Art. III requirement of actual or threatened injury amenable to judicial remedy. But neither the counsels of prudence nor the policies implicit in the "case or controversy" requirement should be mistaken for the rigorous Art. III requirements themselves. Satisfaction of the former cannot substitute for a demonstration of "'distinct and palpable injury' . . . that is likely to be redressed if the requested relief is granted." *Gladstone, Realtors v. Village of Bellwood*, 441 U. S., at 100 (quoting *Warth v. Seldin*, *supra*, at 501). That requirement states a limitation on judicial power, not merely a factor to be balanced in the weighing of so-called "prudential" considerations.

We need not mince words when we say that the concept of "Art. III standing" has not been defined with complete consistency in all of the various cases decided by this Court which have discussed it, nor when we say that this very fact is probably proof that the concept cannot be reduced to a one-sentence or one-paragraph definition. But of one thing we may be sure: Those who do not possess Art. III standing may

¹¹ See *Gladstone, Realtors v. Village of Bellwood*, *supra*, at 100; *Duke Power Co. v. Carolina Environmental Study Group, Inc.*, 438 U. S., at 80.

¹² See *Gladstone, Realtors v. Village of Bellwood*, *supra*, at 100, n. 6; *Simon v. Eastern Kentucky Welfare Rights Org.*, 426 U. S. 26, 39, n. 19 (1976).